

TidyTuesday Week 36

Pranay Gundam

Sunday 6th September, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly parade of numbers that have no business being in the same room together, let alone the same scatterplot. This week our little machine reached into the FRED grab bag five times and pulled out such crowd-pleasers as discontinued small-business loan risk percentages, aggregate weekly hours in durable goods manufacturing, imports of non-manufactured commodities to the U.S. Virgin Islands, and – my personal favorite – grocery inventories versus Southeastern social assistance GDP. Truly the questions that keep economists up at night, if by "economists" you mean "a script running unsupervised at 3 a.m."

We opened Monday with the discontinued SBA loan series versus Ft. Lauderdale house prices, and I regret to inform the tabloids that there is nothing here. The raw regression shrugged (p around 0.33), and the detrended version shrugged even harder. A rare case of the machine correctly identifying that two random things are, in fact, unrelated. Tuesday gave us the week's most instructive little morality play: durable-goods weekly hours versus foreign official demand deposits looked statistically "significant" in the raw run (p about 0.006, gasp, clutch pearls), and then the instant we stripped out each series' own drifting-over-time habit, the whole thing evaporated to a p -value of 0.82. That, dear reader, is the textbook trend mirage this entire project exists to point and laugh at: two things wandering the same general direction over the years, briefly mistaken for friends.

Wednesday flipped the script in the funniest way. Virgin Islands imports versus Dutch services business confidence had absolutely nothing going on in the raw regression (p 0.59), but the detrended version squeaked into "significance" (p about 0.014) – with an R -squared of a heart-stopping 0.027, meaning it explains roughly nothing while technically clearing the bar. Thursday's grocery inventories versus social assistance GDP did something similar, coming alive only after detrending (p 0.037, R -squared a positively electric 0.16). I'd theorize a deep macroeconomic linkage between canned goods and the Southeast's welfare economy, but I'd also like to keep my dignity, so I won't.

The genuine star of the week is Friday: New England premium gasoline prices versus net sales of "all other professional and technical services except legal." The raw regression came in swinging with an R -squared of 0.52 and a p -value with more zeros than my patience, and – plot twist – it survived detrending too (p about 0.034), which is the rare case where I'm contractually obligated to say "huh, that's actually kind of interesting." Maybe pricier gas and busier consulting-adjacent firms both ride the same broader economic tide; maybe it's a coincidence wearing a very convincing costume. Either way, standard disclaimer, shouted from the rooftops: these

are randomly paired series, no theory, no causation, no rigor beyond "the line went diagonal."
Spurious correlation is the house special here, and this week the kitchen was cooking as usual.

2 Date: 2026-08-31

Series ID: EBZMNQ

This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans, Small Business Administration (SBA) Backed for Zero Interval, Moderate Risk, All Commercial Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2012-07-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: ATNHPIUS22744Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Ft. Lauderdale-Pompano Beach-Sunrise, FL (MSAD) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1975-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 14.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS22744Q	R-squared:	0.054			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.001			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.023			
Date:	Mon, 31 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.325			
Time:	18:19:31	Log-Likelihood:	-95.885			
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	195.8			
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	197.8			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	228.2095	7.532	30.297	0.000	212.384	244.035
value_fred_EBZMNQ	-2.5123	2.484	-1.011	0.325	-7.732	2.707
Omnibus:	1.225	Durbin-Watson:	0.142			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.542	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.944			
Skew:	-0.262	Prob(JB):	0.624			
Kurtosis:	2.073	Cond. No.	3.38			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

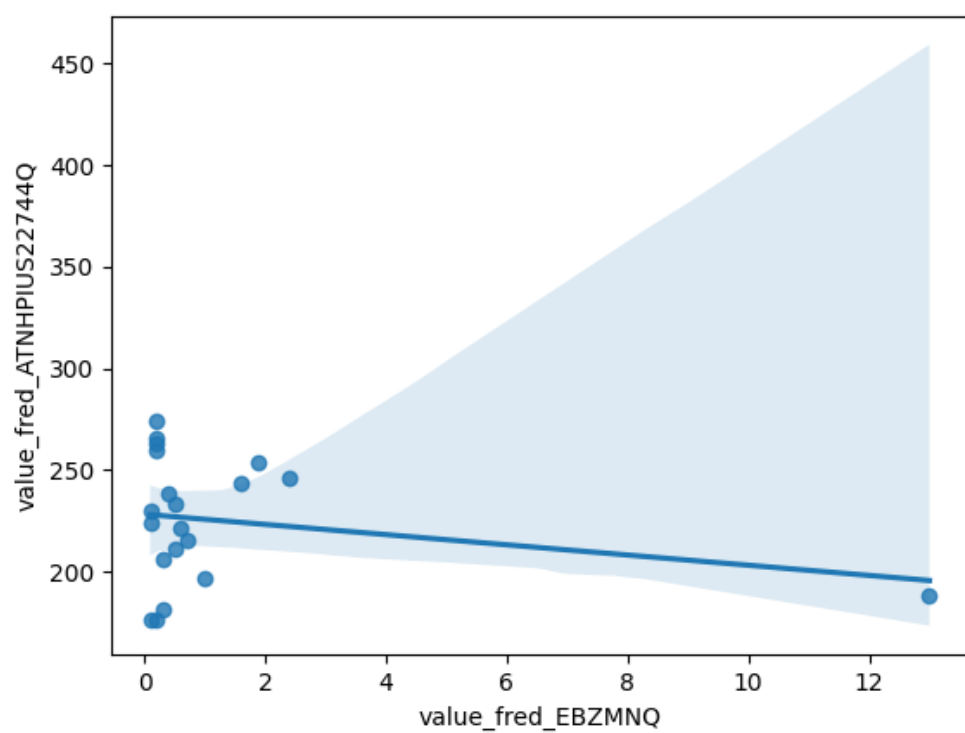


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-31

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS22744Q_detrended	R-squared:	0.096
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.045
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.904
Date:	Mon, 31 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.185
Time:	18:19:31	Log-Likelihood:	-47.327
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	98.65
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	100.6
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.994e-11	0.608	-3.28e-11	1.000	-1.277	1.277
value_fred_EBZMNQ_detrended	-0.3090	0.224	-1.380	0.185	-0.780	0.162

Omnibus:	1.101	Durbin-Watson:	0.883
Prob(Omnibus):	0.577	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.608
Skew:	-0.424	Prob(JB):	0.738
Kurtosis:	2.893	Cond. No.	2.71

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

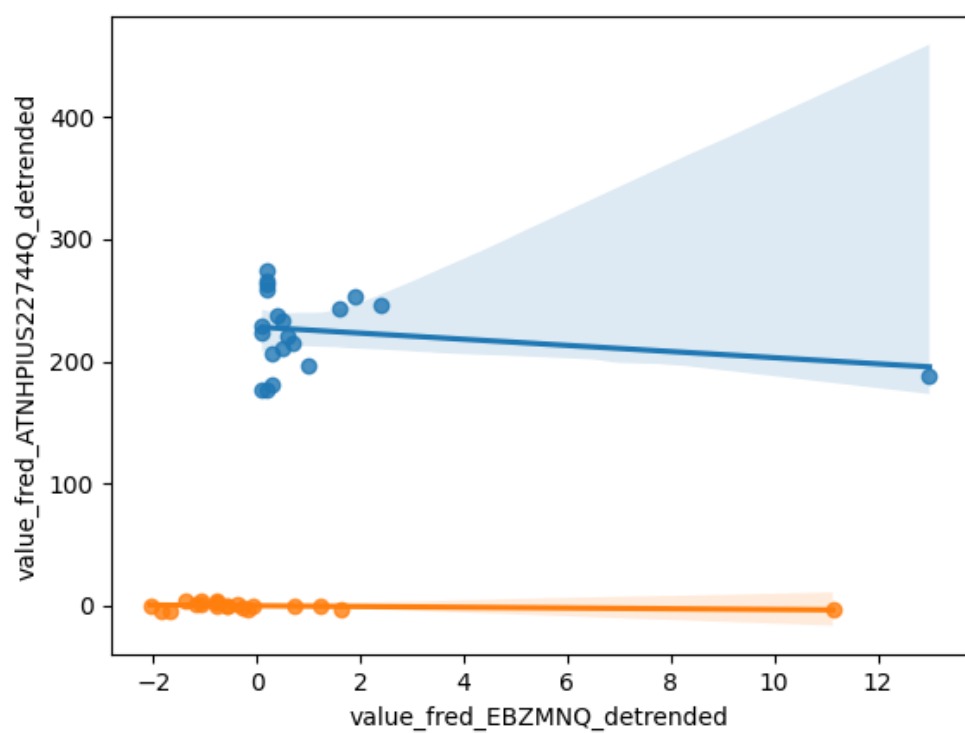


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-31

3 Date: 2026-09-02

Series ID: CEU3100000016

This series is titled Indexes of Aggregate Weekly Hours of All Employees, Durable Goods and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 2007=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2006-03-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: DDDFOINS

This series is titled Demand Deposits at Banks Due to Foreign Official Institutions (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1959-01-01 and the observation end date is 2021-01-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DDDFOINS	R-squared:	0.042
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.036
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	7.715
Date:	Wed, 02 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00607
Time:	15:25:54	Log-Likelihood:	-715.97
No. Observations:	179	AIC:	1436.
Df Residuals:	177	BIC:	1442.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	55.3897	14.155	3.913	0.000	27.455	83.325
value_fred_CEU3100000016	-0.4390	0.158	-2.778	0.006	-0.751	-0.127

Omnibus:	30.591	Durbin-Watson:	0.012
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	40.300
Skew:	1.071	Prob(JB):	1.77e-09
Kurtosis:	3.905	Cond. No.	1.28e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.28e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

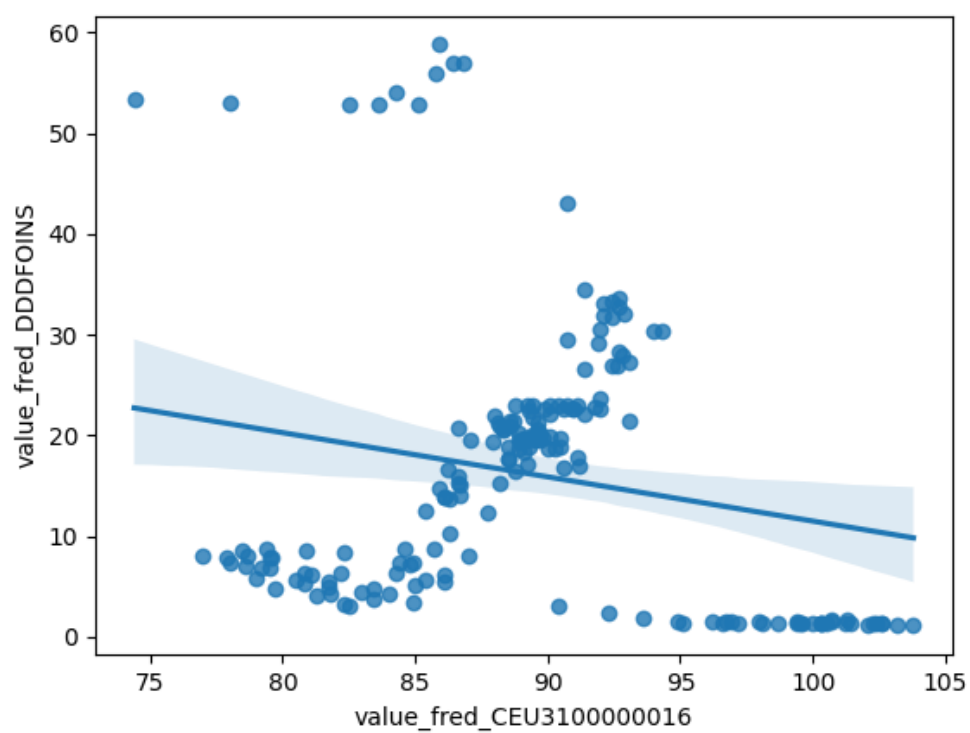


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-02

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DDDFOINS_detrended	R-squared:	0.000
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.005
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.05396
Date:	Wed, 02 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.817
Time:	15:25:54	Log-Likelihood:	-568.24
No. Observations:	179	AIC:	1140.
Df Residuals:	177	BIC:	1147.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.765e-14	0.435	-4.06e-14	1.000	-0.858	0.858
value_fred_CEU3100000016_detrended	-0.0165	0.071	-0.232	0.817	-0.157	0.124

Omnibus:	69.935	Durbin-Watson:	0.069
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	182.593
Skew:	1.695	Prob(JB):	2.24e-40
Kurtosis:	6.605	Cond. No.	6.13

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

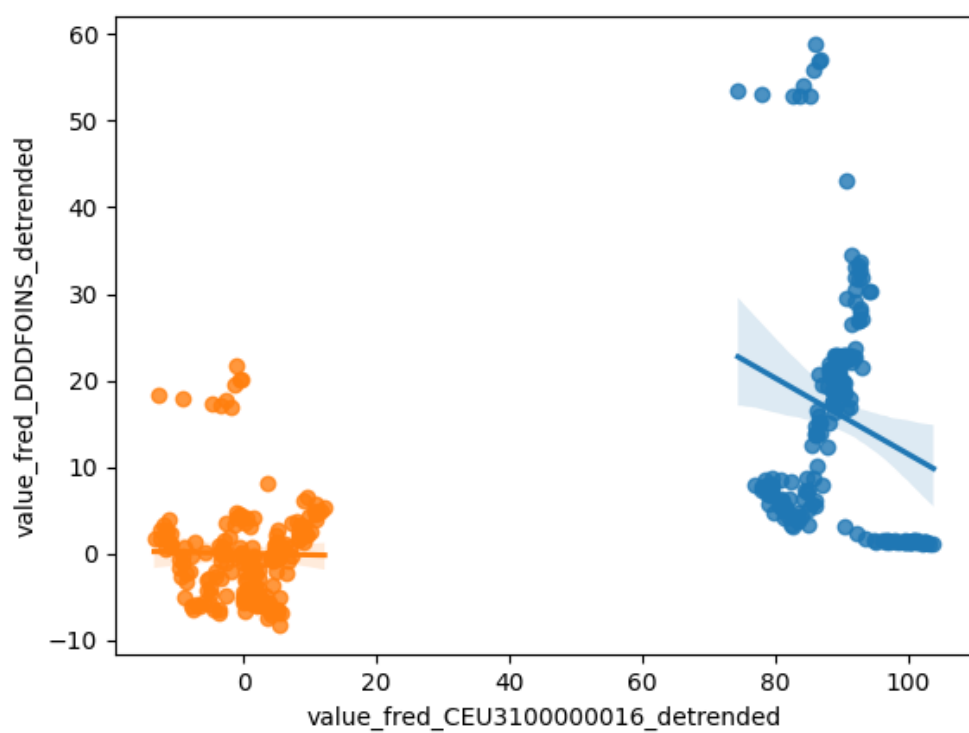


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-02

4 Date: 2026-09-03

Series ID: IMPNONVI

This series is titled Imports of Goods: Non-Manufactured Commodities for U.S. Virgin Islands and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2008-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: BVCICP02NLM460S

This series is titled Business Tendency Surveys: Composite Business Confidence: Economic Activity: Services for Netherlands and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Percentage balance and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BVCICP02NLM460S	R-squared:	0.001
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.003
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.2940
Date:	Thu, 03 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.588
Time:	15:18:46	Log-Likelihood:	-880.07
No. Observations:	222	AIC:	1764.
Df Residuals:	220	BIC:	1771.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	3.2308	0.964	3.350	0.001	1.330	5.131
value_fred_IMPNONVI	-0.0011	0.002	-0.542	0.588	-0.005	0.003

Omnibus:	84.410	Durbin-Watson:	0.133
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	241.891
Skew:	-1.667	Prob(JB):	2.98e-53
Kurtosis:	6.877	Cond. No.	525.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

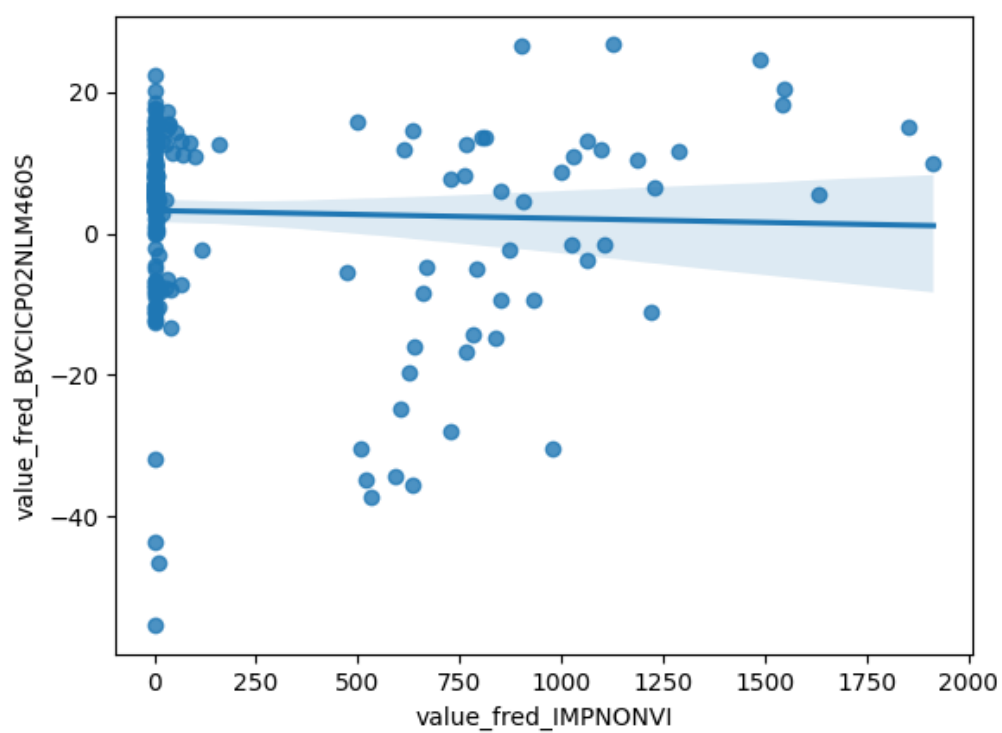


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-03

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BVCICP02NLM460S_detrended	R-squared:	0.027
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.023
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	6.159
Date:	Thu, 03 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0138
Time:	15:18:46	Log-Likelihood:	-871.17
No. Observations:	222	AIC:	1746.
Df Residuals:	220	BIC:	1753.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-5.169e-13	0.826	-6.26e-13	1.000	-1.627	1.627
value_fred_IMPNONVI_detrended	0.0067	0.003	2.482	0.014	0.001	0.012

Omnibus:	85.354	Durbin-Watson:	0.157
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	284.269
Skew:	-1.608	Prob(JB):	1.87e-62
Kurtosis:	7.515	Cond. No.	307.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

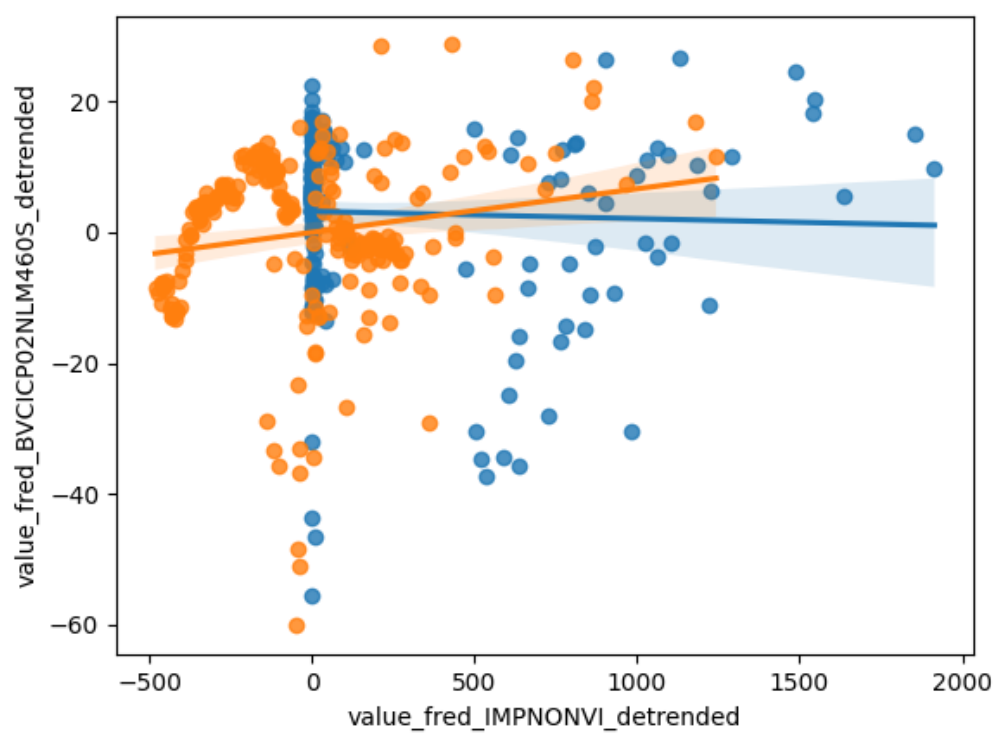


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-03

5 Date: 2026-09-05

Series ID: T4244MM157NCEN

This series is titled Merchant Wholesalers, Except Manufacturers' Sales Branches and Offices: Nondurable Goods: Grocery and Related Products Inventories and has a frequency of Monthly, End of Month. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1992-02-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: SESTSOCASSRGSP

This series is titled Real Gross Domestic Product: Social Assistance (624) in the Southeast BEA Region and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Millions of Chained 2017 Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SESTSOCASSRGSP	R-squared:	0.002
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.036
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.04969
Date:	Sat, 05 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.825
Time:	14:04:49	Log-Likelihood:	-268.33
No. Observations:	28	AIC:	540.7
Df Residuals:	26	BIC:	543.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.963e+04	955.230	20.550	0.000	1.77e+04	2.16e+04
value_fred_T4244MM157NCEN	116.9651	524.731	0.223	0.825	-961.634	1195.564

Omnibus:	0.232	Durbin-Watson:	0.070
Prob(Omnibus):	0.891	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.282
Skew:	-0.188	Prob(JB):	0.869
Kurtosis:	2.684	Cond. No.	2.95

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

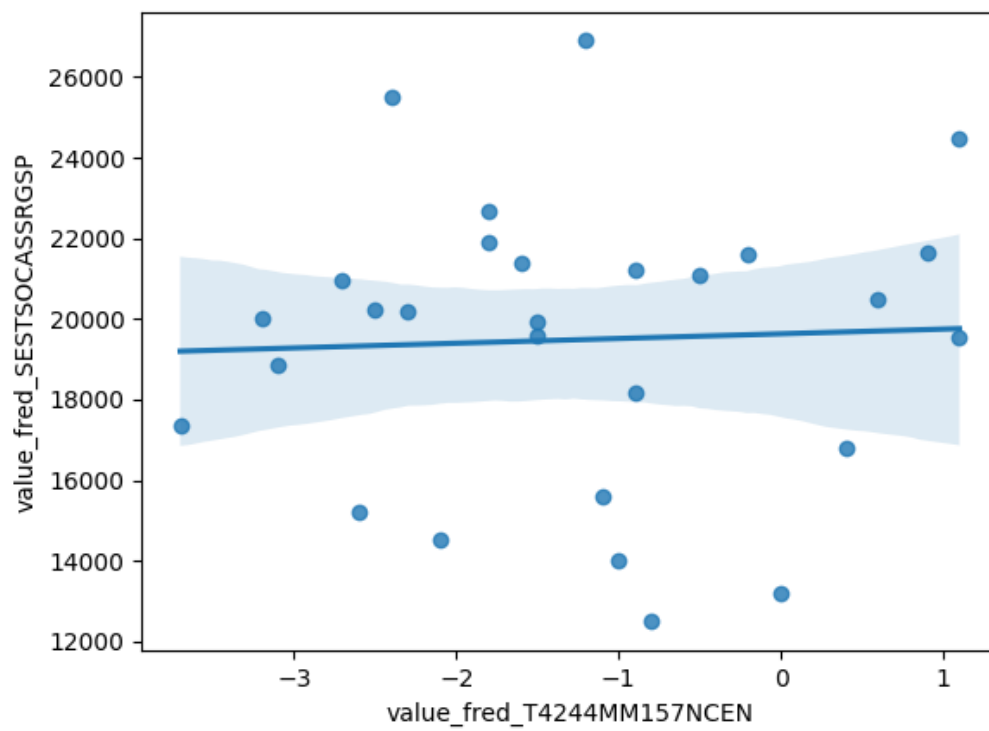


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-05

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SESTSOCASSRGSP_detrended	R-squared:	0.157
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.124
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	4.824
Date:	Sat, 05 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0372
Time:	14:04:49	Log-Likelihood:	-231.94
No. Observations:	28	AIC:	467.9
Df Residuals:	26	BIC:	470.5
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	2.402e-11	187.850	1.28e-13	1.000	-386.131	386.131
value_fred_T4244MM157NCEN_detrended	-318.6464	145.080	-2.196	0.037	-616.862	-20.431

Omnibus:	0.422	Durbin-Watson:	0.936
Prob(Omnibus):	0.810	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.411
Skew:	-0.255	Prob(JB):	0.814
Kurtosis:	2.696	Cond. No.	1.29

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

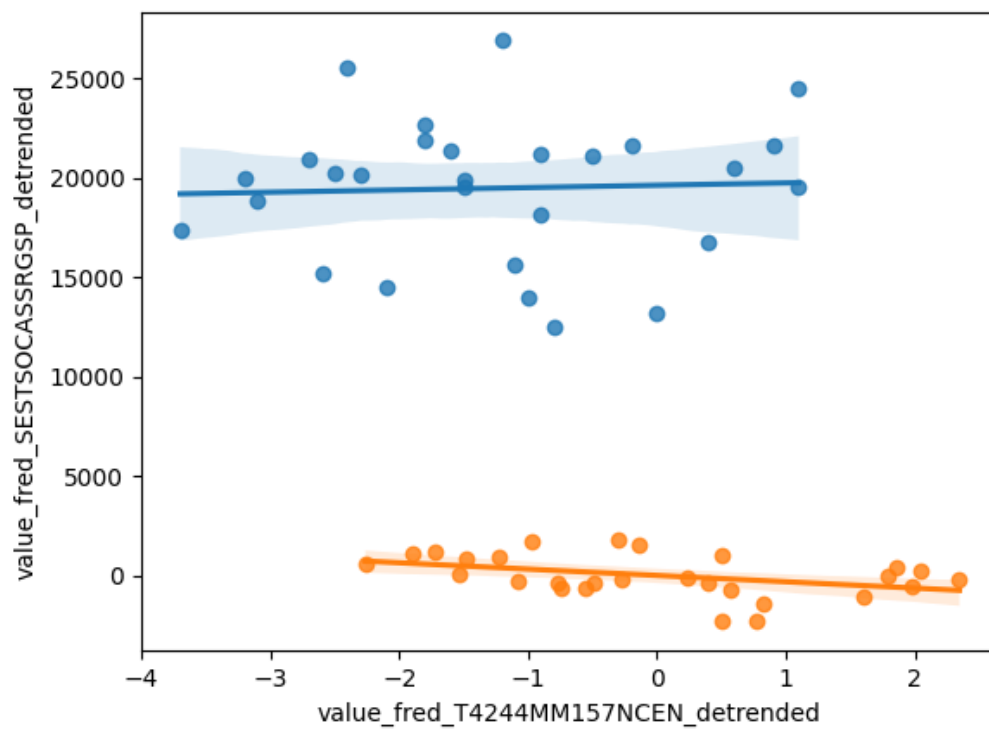


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-05

6 Date: 2026-09-06

Series ID: APU011074716

This series is titled Average Price: Gasoline, Unleaded Premium (Cost per Gallon/3.785 Liters) in the New England Census Division and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2018-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: QFR101549USNO

This series is titled Quarterly Financial Report: U.S. Corporations: All Other Professional and Technical Services, Except Legal Services: Net Sales, Receipts, and Operating Revenues and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2009-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

6.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_QFR101549USNO	R-squared:	0.518
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.503
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	33.37
Date:	Sun, 06 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	2.32e-06
Time:	14:30:55	Log-Likelihood:	-331.49
No. Observations:	33	AIC:	667.0
Df Residuals:	31	BIC:	670.0
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	2.852e+04	5248.264	5.435	0.000	1.78e+04	3.92e+04
value_fred_APU011074716	8170.9133	1414.484	5.777	0.000	5286.053	1.11e+04

Omnibus:	9.060	Durbin-Watson:	0.654
Prob(Omnibus):	0.011	Jarque-Bera (JB):	7.651
Skew:	1.067	Prob(JB):	0.0218
Kurtosis:	4.004	Cond. No.	20.8

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

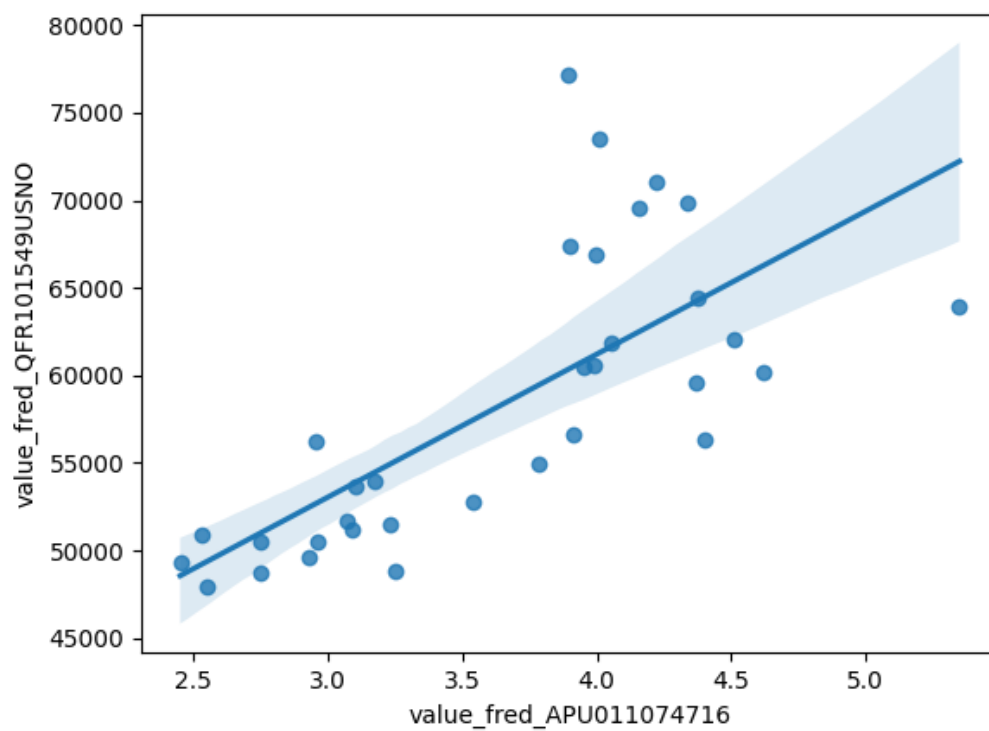


Figure 9: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-06

6.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_QFR101549USNO_detrended	R-squared:	0.137
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.109
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	4.928
Date:	Sun, 06 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0339
Time:	14:30:55	Log-Likelihood:	-323.18
No. Observations:	33	AIC:	650.4
Df Residuals:	31	BIC:	653.4
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.542e-09	778.512	-1.98e-12	1.000	-1587.786	1587.786
value_fred_APU011074716_detrended	3391.3160	1527.650	2.220	0.034	275.654	6506.978

Omnibus:	1.706	Durbin-Watson:	0.705
Prob(Omnibus):	0.426	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.192
Skew:	0.465	Prob(JB):	0.551
Kurtosis:	2.962	Cond. No.	1.96

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

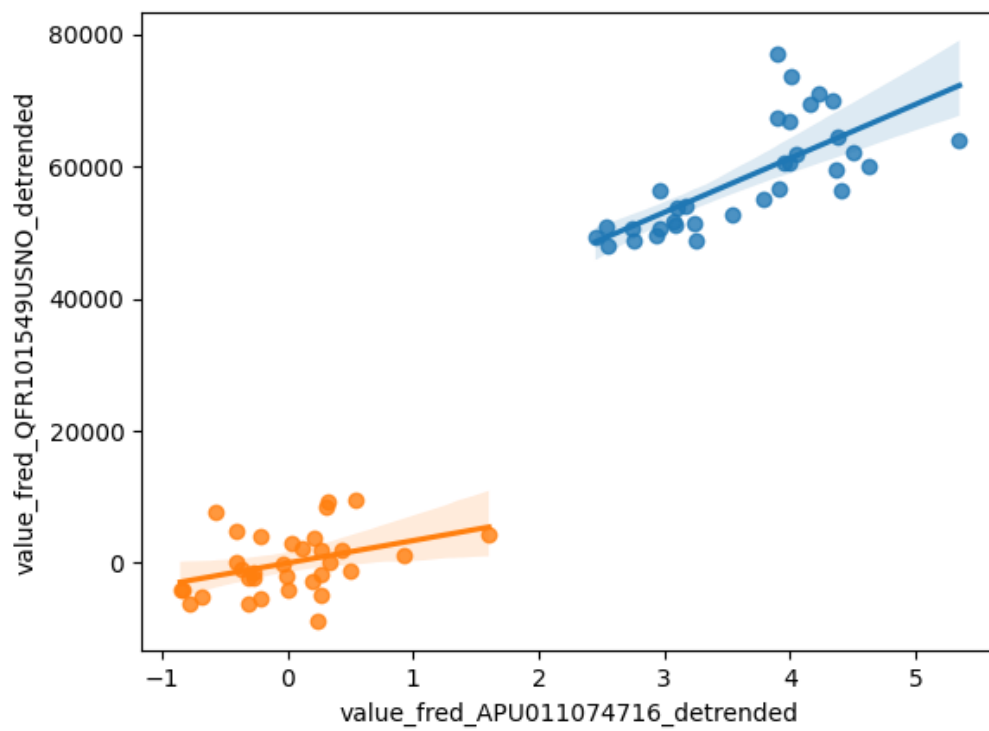


Figure 10: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-06